



T-storm, shower 76/65 • Tomorrow: T-storm, humid 81/67 B6

Democracy Dies in Darkness

WEDNESDAY, MAY 14, 2025 • \$4

FAA has no quick fix for chaos in Newark

Even relocating veteran air traffic controllers can require years of training

BY IAN DUNCAN

The lack of just a dozen air traffic controllers has contributed to danger, chaos, and waves of delays and cancellations at Newark Liberty International Airport. Yet the Federal Aviation Administration — despite employing about 14,000 controllers across the country — is unable to quickly fill the empty slots and restore normal operations.

The reason for that seeming disconnect underscores the depths of the FAA's staffing problems. It also helps explain why, even amid a surge in hiring, controllers and managers in the federally operated towers are required to work massive amounts of overtime, burn out from stress and warn of a system on the brink of crisis.

"We don't have the ability to just snap our fingers and move controllers around," Transportation Secretary Sean P. Duffy told reporters this week.

Each airport in the United States poses unique challenges, from the configuration of runways to potential conflicts in the skies. That means any time a controller moves to a new facility — even a veteran with 20 years under their belt — they must be recertified on each individual job there. In all, the process can take upward of two years.

The Federal Aviation Administration is convening airlines this week in an effort to reduce flights in and out of the Newark airport. The FAA says other fixes will include technology upgrades. While some changes will be made within weeks, the agency said, others might not be complete until the end of the year.

Extra controllers are also in
SEE AIR TRAFFIC ON A2

In Mideast, Trump remakes U.S. foreign policy



WIN MCNAMEE/GETTY IMAGES

"He's an incredible man," President Donald Trump said of Saudi Crown Prince Mohammed bin Salman as he began his three-day trip to the Middle East with a visit to Saudi Arabia. One of Trump's goals is to boost investment from the region in the United States.

Visit overlaps the interests of the family business

Many potential conflicts as president's sons chase real estate deals in region

BY CLEVE R. WOOTSON JR.,
SUSANNAH GEORGE,
EMILY DAVIES
AND TODD C. FRANKEL

President Donald Trump kicked off the first major international trip of his second term Tuesday in a region where his

family business has grown significantly in recent months, presenting his administration with more potential conflicts of interest than ever.

The president's sons, who head the Trump Organization, have spent the past few weeks crisscrossing the Middle East, laying the groundwork for deals that will benefit the company and, in some instances, Trump himself. Government watchdogs, presidential historians and other critics say it is an escalation of unethical and even unconstitutional conflicts between the inter-

ests of the United States and its president.

A week before Trump was scheduled to land in Saudi Arabia for a trip that would also take him to Qatar and the United Arab Emirates, his son Eric spoke to a crowded convention center in Dubai about the Trump Organization's plans to build an 80-floor hotel and residential tower there. He boasted that the "incredible icon" would "redefine luxury" and have the highest infinity-edge pool in the world, overlooking the towering Burj Khalifa building.

"On behalf of myself, on behalf of my family," he said, "we love Dubai. ... We have such a great relationship between the United States and just one of the greatest places and I'm glad to call so many of you friends."

Trump's relationship with the Gulf States offers insight into the instincts of a lifelong businessman who has made a career of selling. Trump has notably declined to duplicate his first-term pledge not to advance his personal business interests from the White House, but he has also
SEE CONFLICTS ON A8

Israel hits hospital, says target was bunker

Reports suggest military was trying to kill a high-level Hamas official

This article is by Miriam Berger, Shira Rubin, Lior Soroka, Claire Parker and Hazem Balousha

JAFFA, ISRAEL — Israel carried out massive strikes on a hospital complex in southern Gaza on Tuesday, causing chaos at the facility, overturning concrete on roads and in the courtyard and leaving gaping craters from a raid the military said targeted an underground bunker used by Hamas.

At least 28 people were killed in the attack on the European Hospital, according to Gaza's civil defense force. In a statement, the Israeli military said it targeted Hamas operatives "in an underground terrorist infrastructure site."

Two people familiar with the matter, speaking on the condition
SEE GAZA ON A11



DEREK DAVIS/PORTLAND (MAINE) PRESS HERALD/GETTY IMAGES

Jordon Hudson, third from left, was second runner-up in the Miss Maine USA pageant Sunday.

The coach, his 'muse' and a mess

As Belichick's 24-year-old girlfriend shapes his image, a firestorm erupts

BY ADAM KILGORE,
JESSE DOUGHERTY
AND BEN STRAUSS

PORTLAND, MAINE — Jordon Hudson stepped down from a riser and toward the middle of the Miss Maine USA pageant stage, where an emcee held a microphone and a question chosen at random. He began with small talk that happened to be on the minds of sports fans

and tabloid rubberneckers across the country: "How are you doing?"

A few feet from the stage, in the front row, sat Bill Belichick — six-time Super Bowl winner with the New England Patriots, the University of North Carolina's new coach and, at 73, boyfriend of the 24-year-old Hudson. Their romance and professional partnership, combined with the public's appetite

for any crumb of information about both, had vaulted Hudson into prominence and controversy. Life in that spotlight, she had recently written her former cheerleading team, had led to "a slow, exterior erasure of my strong, individual identity."

But for at least a few more moments Sunday afternoon, inside a Holiday Inn ballroom, SEE BELICHICK ON A6

Singer testifies about Combs's alleged abuse

Witness tells jury the producer often coerced her into sex with escorts

BY ANNE BRANIGIN,
JANAY KINGSBERRY
AND SHAYNA JACOBS

NEW YORK — R&B singer Cassandra "Cassie" Ventura took the stand Tuesday as the prosecution's star witness in Sean "Diddy" Combs's federal sex trafficking trial, delivering explosive and emotional testimony with detailed allegations of physical, sexual and psychological abuse by the music mogul during their 10-year romantic relationship.

Her appearance at the Daniel Patrick Moynihan U.S. Court-

house in Manhattan marked a dramatic moment in the government's case against Combs, who is charged with five criminal counts of racketeering conspiracy, sex trafficking and transportation to engage in prostitution. Combs seemed to closely watch his former girlfriend as she was sworn in by Judge Arun Subramanian and addressed the jury for the first time. Ventura appeared to have no interest in returning his gaze. The producer has pleaded not guilty to all charges and faces 15 years to life in prison if convicted on all counts.

During her testimony, Ventura recounted her time with Combs — beginning with what she considered an inappropriate kiss from him when he was her boss at the start of her career, and continuing into a years-long relationship in
SEE COMBS ON A4



JOHN MINCHILLO/AP



AP

MLB reinstates Rose, 'Shoeless' Joe
The removal of Pete Rose and "Shoeless" Joe Jackson from the permanently ineligible list means they could be voted into the Baseball Hall of Fame. **D1**

IN THE NEWS

Republicans' bill The massive tax and immigration package backed by President Donald Trump would reshape much of the federal government and the U.S. economy. **A4**

Detained researcher Before his arrest, a little-known Georgetown fellow came to the attention of conservative advocacy groups. **B1**

THE NATION
Omaha's mayoral election is the latest gauge of attitudes on Democrats and Trump. **A3**
A wartime law can be used for deportations in Pennsylvania, with more notice, a judge ruled. **A6**

THE WORLD
Moscow and Kyiv are poised to hold their first high-level face-to-face talks since 2022 in Turkey, with U.S. officials also expected to attend, as the fighting in Ukraine grinds on. **A10**

THE ECONOMY
Personal-finance classes are now required in a growing number of high schools, and many students are eager to apply the lessons. **A14**
Inflation ticked up month over month in April, but the annual pace of price increases eased unexpectedly. **A18**

THE REGION
Ed Martin, the outgoing interim U.S. attorney for D.C., said that in his new role he will review Biden-era pardons. **B1**
In a reversal, the U.S. government will give a 14-acre property to the University of Virginia instead of Charlottesville public schools. **B1**

STYLE
With his new play, the creator of "Mad Men" is focusing on someone even madder: presidential assassin John Wilkes Booth. **C1**

FOOD
Etiquette experts and workplace gurus share the definitive rules of eating in the office. **E1**

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